Don Polistico

Designer | Brooklyn, NY | 929-969-4242 | don@polisti.co | don.polisti.co | LinkedIn

Summary

Designer with 15+ years in streaming video and consumer electronics. Three teams I've been part of were acquired: Boxee by Samsung, VHX by Vimeo, and Vimeo by Bending Spoons. I design consumer products for TV, mobile, and web, with contract work in holographic displays and decentralized social. Since 2025 I've worked from design straight into shipped projects with agentic AI tools.

Experience

Independent practice | **Designer** | Brooklyn, NY | June 2025 – Present

- **Built don-os**, a versioned set of files covering my taste, voice, workflow, and quality standards, so every AI tool I use starts from the same context.
- **Run a team of AI assistants** (Claude, Gemini, Muse, and Dot) on top of **don-os**, each with a defined role. Claude is the architect and planner, Gemini is the builder, Muse handles financial planning, and Dot creates 3D models of my home for a renovation.
- **Rebuilt my portfolio site with agentic tools.** Multiple peers and AI assistants audited it independently. I merged their findings into one plan and made the calls where they disagreed, then directed the agents through shipped changes, checking each one on the live site rather than trusting their reports.
- **Designed and shipped a custom local AI assistant** on a Mac Mini that syncs its context from don-os automatically.

Vimeo | **Senior Product Designer** | New York, NY | June 2016 – June 2025

- **Led design for Vimeo Streaming** (OTT) across **11+ platforms** (web, iOS, Android, tvOS, Android TV, Roku, Fire TV, Samsung, LG), a product powering **$429M+ in annual creator revenue** and **5,000+ launched channels**.
- **Designed the App Builder 0→1**, a no-code publishing tool built on a modular template system with platform compliance (Apple, Roku, Amazon, Google) built in by default, replacing custom-built apps with self-serve publishing creators could launch on their own.
- Defined interaction patterns for the Vimeo player, balancing craft with technical feasibility across devices supporting **millions of daily plays**.
- Carried the product through three company-defining shifts: the VHX integration after the 2016 acquisition, the pivot from creator tool to B2B platform, and the run-up to the Bending Spoons acquisition.
- Built and maintained the shared design system (components, patterns, documentation) for web and mobile as the product surface scaled.

VHX | **Senior Product Designer** | Brooklyn, NY | October 2015 – June 2016

- Designed direct-to-consumer video distribution tools for independent creators, focusing on payment flows and audience management.
- Partnered with developers to launch custom OTT streaming apps, establishing the foundational patterns later adopted by Vimeo.

Samsung | **Senior Product Designer** | New York, NY | July 2013 – October 2015

- Designed and prototyped multi-screen user experiences for Samsung's Smart TV ecosystem and connected devices.
- Collaborated with global engineering teams to integrate software interfaces into next-generation Samsung TV hardware.

Boxee | **Designer** | New York, NY | July 2010 – July 2013

- Designed the **0→1 Cloud DVR** experience (recording, series scheduling, conflict resolution) and social TV features, inventing 10-foot UI patterns years before tvOS or Android TV conventions existed.
- Designed the out-of-box experience (under 5 minutes from unboxing to first content) and contributed to the dual-sided QWERTY remote, packaging, and retail launch materials.

Contract & consulting

Looking Glass | **Senior Product Designer (Contract)** | Brooklyn, NY | 2022 – 2024

- Designed and shipped the 0→1 companion app for the Looking Glass Go holographic display on iOS, Android, and web, including AI-powered 2D→3D depth conversion flows.
- Defined explicit hardware states (connecting, syncing, firmware update, ready) and a design system bridging 2D desktop workflows with 3D spatial output.

Primitives.xyz | **Senior Product Designer (Contract)** | New York, NY | 2022 – 2024

- Designed the end-to-end Creator app for iOS and mobile web while optimizing the core web experience for a decentralized social sharing protocol.
- Partnered with the founding team to translate complex Web3 primitives into intuitive mobile interfaces, focusing on onboarding and content creation tools.

Recount Media | **Senior Product Designer (Contract)** | New York, NY | 2020

- Designed mobile-first video discovery features for the political news platform, optimizing the watch flow to increase viewer retention.
- Partnered with editorial and engineering teams to rapidly prototype and launch new content formats for daily news cycles.

One Month | **Designer (Contract)** | New York, NY | 2013 – 2014

- Collaborated with the founder during the Y Combinator (S13) incubator to design the MVP interface and translate technical curriculums into intuitive user flows, helping the team secure early traction and seed funding.

Skills & Tools

- **Tools:** Figma, FigJam, Claude Code, Google Antigravity, AI prototyping and agentic workflows, prototyping in code.
- **Platforms:** iOS, Android, responsive web, tvOS, Android TV, Roku, Fire TV, Samsung Tizen, XBOX, LG webOS
- **Craft:** Design systems, 10-foot UI, interaction design, information architecture, monetization and payment flows, usability testing, user interviews, accessibility.

Education

Maryland Institute College of Art (MICA) | BFA in Design

- Winner of the Stempel Thesis Prize Award for exemplary senior thesis work. https://vimeo.com/donosaur/script

Johns Hopkins University | Engineering Coursework

Additional

Owner-operator of a two-unit residential building in Brooklyn (repair/maintenance/renovation management, tenant relations, P&L).